

BBC 6 Minute English Listening Practice

Learning Multiple Languages

Name: _____

Class: _____

Score: _____ / 20

No.	Sentence
1	A person who knows many languages is called a _____.
2	Research suggests that knowing more than one language can change the _____.
3	Even before speaking, babies need to pay _____ to the languages around them.
4	Children who use several languages must focus on one language and _____ another.
5	In bilingual adults with dementia, symptoms may appear after a _____.
6	Managing several languages can improve brain _____.
7	Hannah says she did not learn languages out of _____.
8	Victoria speaks five languages and understands _____.
9	Her family moved from Rwanda to Kenya and then to _____.
10	Victoria recommends language _____, such as listening to people in markets or streets.

11 **What has research suggested about knowing more than one language?**

- A It may affect the brain and bring health benefits.
- B It makes people speak faster in every language.
- C It prevents children from learning their first language.
- D It removes the need for formal education.

12 **What do babies in multilingual environments need to do?**

- A Choose one language and stop hearing the others.
- B Listen carefully to the languages around them.
- C Speak all languages before they understand them.
- D Learn grammar rules before they can communicate.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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- 13 **What skill do multilingual children practise when speaking?**
- A Translating every word into their mother tongue.
 - B Focusing on one language while setting another aside.
 - C Using the same language with every person.
 - D Avoiding difficult conversations.
- 14 **What difference is mentioned between bilinguals and monolinguals with dementia?**
- A Bilinguals may show symptoms later.
 - B Monolinguals never develop symptoms.
 - C Bilinguals recover more quickly.
 - D Monolinguals forget all languages first.
- 15 **Why is juggling several languages compared to a brain workout?**
- A It may make the brain work more efficiently.
 - B It is physically tiring like sports training.
 - C It requires people to avoid using their first language.
 - D It works only for people who start as babies.
- 16 **How did Neil's motivation for language learning change later in life?**
- A He became more motivated when he worked abroad.
 - B He stopped learning because languages were too difficult.
 - C He found school language lessons more useful than work.
 - D He learned languages mainly to pass university exams.
- 17 **How was Hannah's experience different from Neil's?**
- A She found languages easier at school and university.
 - B She learned languages only after moving abroad.
 - C She avoided learning languages until adulthood.
 - D She learned languages because her job required it.
- 18 **Why did Victoria learn several languages?**
- A Her family moved between different countries.
 - B She wanted to become a language teacher.
 - C Her school required eight official languages.
 - D She studied them all at university.

19 **Why did Victoria's parents continue learning Norwegian even though it was hard?**

- A They needed it to work and live in Norway.
- B Their children refused to speak their mother tongue.
- C They wanted to become professional translators.
- D They already knew many European languages.

20 **What advice does Victoria give for learning a language?**

- A Surround yourself with real examples of the language.
- B Memorise grammar before listening to people.
- C Avoid public places until you speak perfectly.
- D Learn only through online lessons.